2024

Drinking Water Quality

Consumer Confidence Report

EWEB
Eugene Water & Electric Board

eweb.org/water-quality

Clean water starts at the source

As an EWEB customer, you receive some of the highest quality drinking water in the world

Your water comes from the pristine McKenzie River, which emerges from Clear Lake, high in the Cascade Mountains. Clear Lake is a spring-fed lake, the water bubbling to the surface through acres of natural volcanic "filters," before flowing 85 miles down the McKenzie River to the Hayden Bridge Water Filtration Plant in Springfield, where the Eugene Water & Electric Board (EWEB) draws water from the river.

EWEB has completed a Source Water Assessment to identify potential contaminants of concern for our drinking water. Although the McKenzie River has faced some major challenges over the last few years, overall water quality remains excellent. EWEB works with residents throughout the watershed to minimize contaminants from pesticides and urban runoff, and coordinates with multiple emergency responders to prepare for potential hazardous material spills. With climate change bringing warmer and drier weather, our watershed will endure greater threats in the forms of droughts, wildfires, and harmful algal blooms.

For more information about EWEB's source water monitoring and protection program visit www.eweb.org/sourcewaterprotection.

For contacts and more information, see back cover.

Para obtener contactos y más información, consulte la contraportada.

This report is a summary of the quality of water that EWEB provided to customers in 2024. We are happy to confirm that your water meets and exceeds all state and federal drinking water health standards and that EWEB retains our "Outstanding Performer" status with the Oregon Health Authority (OHA).

Definitions and abbreviations

90th Percentile Value
This means that 90 percent of the samples collected were equal to or below the value reported.

Action Level (AL)
The concentration of a contaminant which, if exceeded, triggers treatment.

Highest Locational Running Annual Average (LRAA)
The highest calculated average of multiple results at a single location in a 12-month period.

Maximum Contaminant Level (MCL)
The highest level of a contaminant that is allowed in drinking water. MCLs are set as close to the MCLG as feasible using the best available treatment technology.

Maximum Contaminant Level Goal (MCLG)
The level of a contaminant in drinking water below which there is no known or expected risk to health. MCLGs allow for a margin of safety.

n/a
Non-Applicable

ND
Contaminant not detectable using current monitoring equipment and methods.

Nephelometric Turbidity Units (NTU)
A measure of water clarity.

Parts Per Billion (ppb)
One part per billion corresponds to one penny in $10,000,000 or approximately one minute in 2,000 years.

Parts Per Million (ppm)
One part per million corresponds to one penny in $10,000 or approximately one minute in two years.

Treatment Technique (TT)
A required process intended to reduce the level of a contaminant in drinking water.

2024 Regulated Contaminant Results

Your water met or exceeded all state and federal drinking water health standards

This report provides a snapshot of last year's water quality. EWEB is proud to say that we have never violated a maximum contaminant level or any other water quality standard established by the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). For information on EWEB's drinking water monitoring program go to www.eweb.org/water-quality, call 541-685-7861, or email water.quality@eweb.org.

The following regulated contaminants were detected in the water. To view a comprehensive list of all the contaminants that EWEB tested for in 2024, visit https://www.eweb.org/documents/Reports%20and%20Publications/testing-summary%202024.pdf.

Test	MCL	MCLG	Detection Range	Probable Source	In Compliance?
Inorganics					
Barium (ppm)	2	2	ND - 0.002	Erosion of natural deposits	**Yes**
Fluoride (ppm)	4	4	ND - 0.057	Erosion of natural deposits	**Yes**
Nitrate (ppm)	10	10	ND - 0.15	Runoff from fertilizer use; Leaching from septic tanks, sewage; Erosion of natural deposits	**Yes**
Disinfection Byproducts					
Total Trihalomethanes (ppb)	80	n/a	8.0 - 22 Highest LRAA: 16.8	Byproduct of drinking water disinfection	**Yes**
Haloacetic Acids (ppb)	60	n/a	4.5 - 8.2 Highest LRAA: 7.4	Byproduct of drinking water disinfection	**Yes**
Chlorine (ppm)	4	4	0.19 - 0.81	Added to control microbes	**Yes**
Total Organic Carbon (ppm)	TT	n/a	0.26 - 0.73	Naturally present in the environment	**Yes**
Microbiological					
Turbidity (NTU)	TT<0.3 95% of the time	n/a	Highest result: 0.038	Soil run-off	**Yes**

Copper and lead sampling results

The State requires EWEB to collect samples from 50 high-risk residential water taps once every three years. The following table represents our most recent testing results from 2024. See page 2 for an explanation of acronyms.

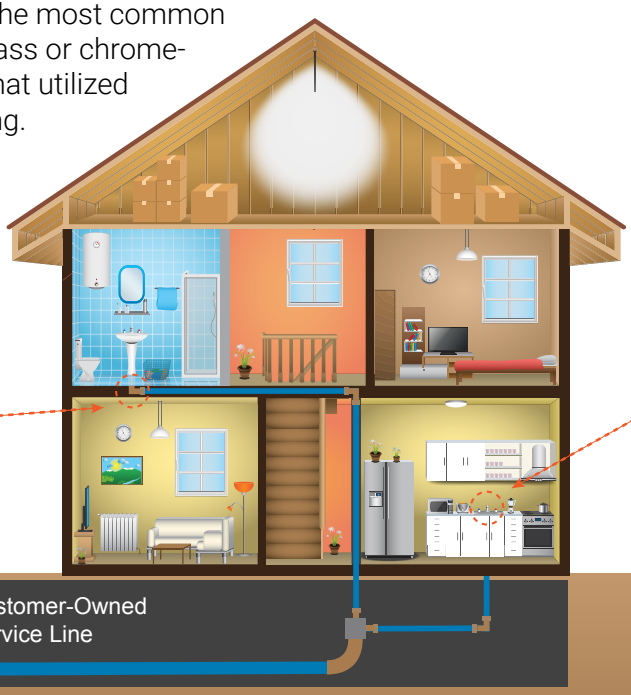
Contaminant	Action Level (AL)	MCLG	90th Percentile Result	Result Range	Samples Exceeding AL	Source of Contamination
Copper (ppm)	1.3	1.3	0.070	0.007-0.094	0	Corrosion of household plumbing systems
Lead (ppb)	15	0	4.5	ND-9.7	0	

How lead could get into your household drinking water

If present, elevated levels of lead can cause serious health problems, especially for pregnant women and young children. Lead in drinking water is primarily from materials and components associated with service lines and home plumbing.

EWEB is responsible for providing high quality drinking water to your meter, but cannot control the variety of materials used in plumbing components once water leaves EWEB-owned service lines. In Eugene, the most common sources of lead in drinking water are brass or chrome-plated brass faucets and other piping that utilized lead solder in customer-owned plumbing.

Copper Pipe with Lead Solder:
Solder made or installed before 1986 contained high lead levels.



Faucets:
Fixtures made prior to 2014 may contain leaded brass.

EWEB-OWNED

Service lines:
There are no known lead service lines in our distribution system.

Meters:
EWEB uses lead-free meters.

CUSTOMER-OWNED

Household plumbing:

The main source of lead in our community's tap water is from old household plumbing. Household plumbing is the homeowner's portion of the service line, which runs from the meter to your house and the type of internal plumbing and faucets used inside your home. You share the responsibility for protecting yourself and your family from the lead in your plumbing by identifying and removing lead materials.

How we reduce the risk of lead in our drinking water system

EWEB has tested our water for lead for decades. The testing shows there is no lead in the water that enters the distribution piping. We also adjust the pH of the water to reduce corrosion in our pipe systems and to help prevent lead from leaching out of old household plumbing fixtures. EWEB is considered optimized by the Oregon Health Authority in our corrosion prevention and is in compliance with all lead regulations.

In 2023, EWEB completed a visual inspection of hundreds of randomly-selected service lines to comply with a new rule from the Oregon Health Authority. No lead service lines were found. We now have a 95% confidence that there are no customer-owned lead service lines in our system. This inventory is available at eweb.org/lead-inventory. If your home was built before 1986, you may want to verify the type of piping that you have running to and through your home. Visit this website for a step-by-step tutorial: https://apps.npr.org/find-lead-pipes-in-your-home/en/#.

How you can reduce your lead exposure

Boiling water will not reduce or remove lead from water. Here are some steps you can take to reduce or eliminate exposure to lead in tap water:

- **Flush your pipes.** Before drinking or cooking, let your water run until it becomes as cold as possible and reaches a steady temperature. If the water has undergone recent use, such as showering or running the dishwasher, this could take as little as 30 seconds. If the water has been sitting for six hours or more it could take several minutes.
- **Use only cold water to drink, cook and make baby formula.** Hot water makes it easier for lead to leach from your pipes into the drinking water.
- **Clean your aerator every few months.** Your faucet aerator can trap particles that contain lead.
- **Consider buying low-lead fixtures.** As of January 4, 2014, all pipes, fittings and fixtures must contain less than 0.25 percent lead. Learn how to identify lead-free products, at https://nepis.epa.gov/Exe/ZyPDF.cgi?Dockey=P100LVYK.txt.
- **Consider using a water filter.** Contact National Sanitation Foundation International at 1-800-673-8010, or visit www.nsf.org for information about certified water filters. Follow all filter maintenance instructions to keep your water safe.

Concerned about lead in your drinking water?

If you are concerned about lead in your water, you may wish to have your water tested. Information on lead in drinking water, testing methods, and steps you can take to minimize exposure is available from the Safe Drinking Water Hotline 1-800-426-4791 or at www.epa.gov/safewater/lead.

Visit https://www.oregon.gov/oha/PH/HEALTHYENVIRONMENTS/DRINKINGWATER/MONITORING/Pages/labs.aspx to learn how you can have your tap water tested for lead.

Let's Get the Lead Out. Watch this video from the American Water Works Association to learn more about where lead comes from: www.youtube.com/watch?v=PqFHrae92OM.

Learn more by visiting EWEB's lead information page at eweb.org/water/lead.

What the EPA says about drinking water contaminants

Drinking water, including bottled water, may reasonably be expected to contain at least small amounts of some contaminants. The presence of contaminants does not necessarily indicate water poses a health risk. More information about contaminants and potential health effects can be obtained by calling the EPA's Safe Drinking Water Hotline at 1-800-426-4791 or visiting: www.epa.gov/ground-water-and-drinking-water/safe-drinking-water-information.

The sources of drinking water (both tap and bottled water) include rivers, lakes, streams, ponds, reservoirs, springs and wells. As water travels over the surface of the land or through the ground, it dissolves naturally-occurring minerals and, in some cases, radioactive material, and can pick up substances resulting from the presence of animals or from human activity.

In order to ensure that tap water is safe to drink, EPA prescribes regulations that limit the amount of certain contaminants in water provided by public water systems. Food and Drug Administration regulations establish limits for contaminants in bottled water which must provide the same protection for public health.

Contaminants in drinking water sources may include:

Microbial contaminants such as viruses and bacteria, which may come from wildlife or septic systems.

Inorganic contaminants such as salts and metals, which can occur naturally or result from urban storm water runoff, industrial or domestic wastewater discharges and farming.

Pesticides and herbicides which may come from a variety of sources such as farming and forestry activities, urban storm water runoff, and home or business landscaping activities.

Organic chemical contaminants including synthetic and volatile organic chemicals, which are byproducts of industrial processes. These substances also can come from gas stations, urban storm water runoff and septic systems.

Radioactive contaminants can occur naturally or may result from oil and gas production and mining activities.

Special health considerations

Some people may be more vulnerable to contaminants in drinking water than the general population. Immuno-compromised persons such as those with cancer undergoing chemotherapy, persons who have undergone organ transplants, people with HIV/AIDS or other immune system disorders, some elderly, and infants can be particularly at risk from infections. These people should seek advice about drinking water from their health care providers. EPA/CDC guidelines on appropriate means to lessen the risk of infection by Cryptosporidium and other microbial contaminants are available from the Safe Drinking Water Hotline (1-800-426-4791).

Notes on EWEB-detected contaminants

The following provides additional information about the contaminants that were detected:

Chlorine

EWEB adds chlorine to our water during the disinfection process to protect against microorganisms such as Giardia and E. coli.

Copper

Copper is found in natural deposits and is also widely used in household plumbing materials.

Turbidity

Turbidity is a measure of the cloudiness of water. It can interfere with disinfection. EWEB's filtration process effectively removes turbidity.

Barium/Fluoride

These naturally-occurring substances, found in the mineral composition of our watershed, were detected at extremely low levels — well below regulatory standards.

Total Organic Carbon

A measure of naturally-occurring organic materials in water.

Disinfection Byproducts (DBPs)

Disinfectants are an essential element in drinking water treatment because of the barrier they provide against waterborne disease-causing microorganisms. DBPs form when disinfectants used to treat drinking water react with naturally-occurring materials in the water (e.g., decomposing plant and other organic material).

Nitrate

Nitrate is an essential component of living things and occurs naturally in surface and groundwater at concentrations up to 1-2 mg/L. At these naturally-occurring levels, nitrate is not harmful to health.

Boil-water advisories

A "boil-water advisory" is a precautionary notice issued when a community's drinking water is or could be contaminated by disease-causing organisms. It is a preventive measure that is intended to protect the health of water consumers when there is an actual or significant possibility that contamination may be present within the drinking water system. In 2024, EWEB issued 12 boil-water advisories due to loss of water pressure in distribution pipes.

Date	Location	Customers Affected
1/17/2024	Capital Dr	6
5/23/2024	Patterson St & Hilyard St	11
7/12/2024	Barger Dr & W Port St	29
7/16/2024	Lawrence St	4
7/20/2024	Cross St	1
7/21/2024	Dove St	16
7/21/2024	Van Ave	8
10/16/2024	Madison St and W 28th Ave	4
10/25/2024	Wilson Dr	2
11/4/2024	City View 1150	35
12/26/2024	S Louis Ln	3
12/29/2024	S Louis Ln	3

EWEB uses door hangers to alert customers of boil-water notices and follow up once water is safe to consume.

Restoring Service

For all advisories, the system was repaired and water pressure restored within a few hours. EWEB then tested water samples for the presence of bacteria. Results from these tests were available after 18 hours, and in all cases EWEB was able to notify the affected customers that the water was safe for consumption. The health of the community is our top priority and EWEB will continue to follow best practices to reduce the risk of contamination entering the water system.

In a water emergency, please call 541-685-7595.

For water quality questions or to request a printed copy of this document, please call 541-685-7861 or email water.quality@eweb.org.

For general EWEB questions, please call 541-685-7000 or email eweb.answers@eweb.org.

EWEB's elected Board of Commissioners holds public meetings the first Tuesday of every month. Learn more at www.eweb.org/board.

Para una copia de este informe en español, contáctenos en eweb.answers@eweb.org o 541-685-7000.

DRINK EUGENE TAP WATER

EWEB

EUGENE WATER & ELECTRIC BOARD

4200 Roosevelt Blvd; Eugene, OR 97402
541-685-7000 • www.eweb.org